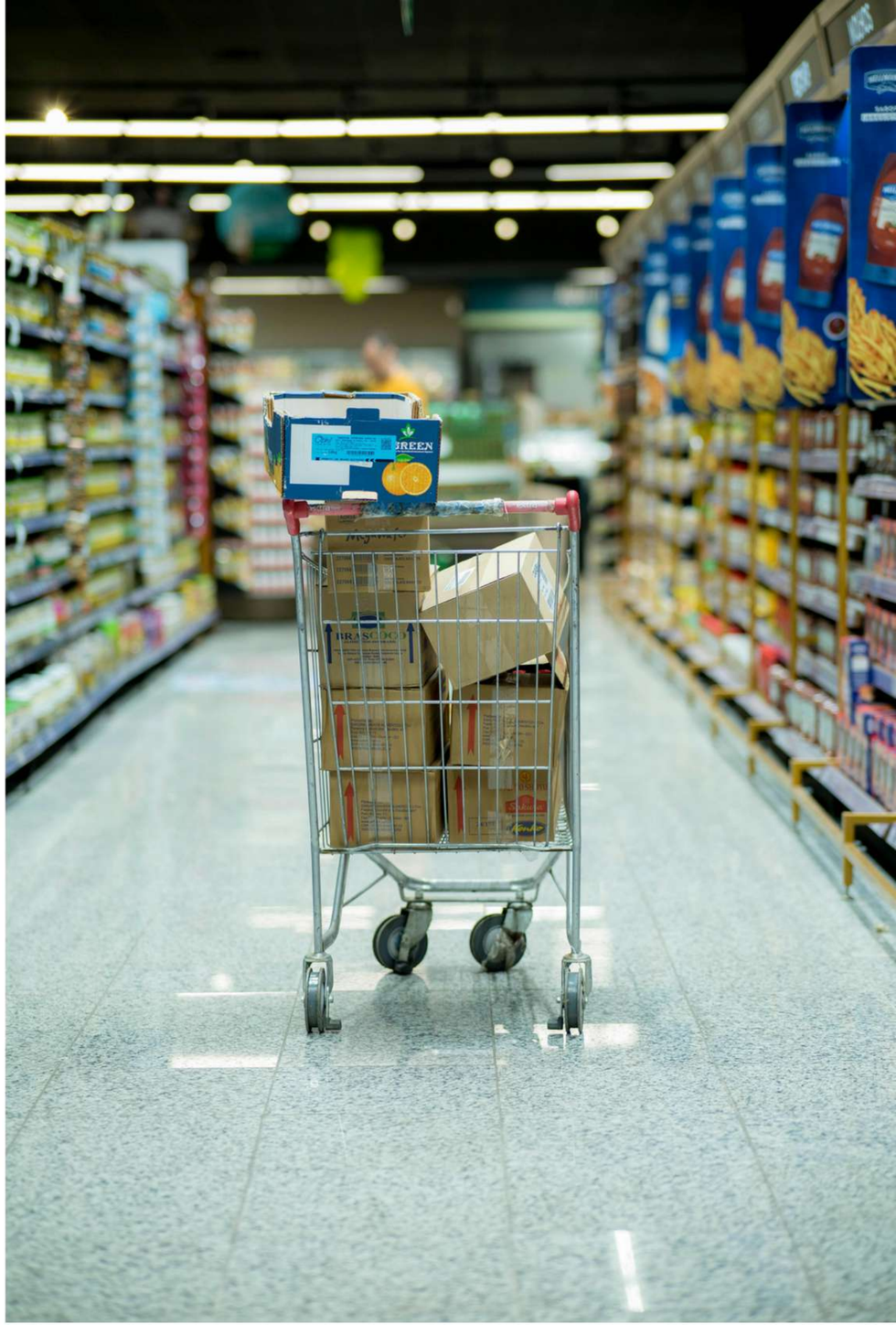
Apr 2026

Category review: Chips

Retail Analytics



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Our 17 year history assures best practice in privacy, security and the ethical use of data

Privacy

- We have built our business based on privacy by design principles for the past 17 years
- Quantium has strict protocols around the receipt and storage of personal information
- All information is de-identified using an irreversible tokenisation process with no ability to re-identify individuals.

Security

- We are ISO27001 certified - internationally recognised for our ability to uphold best practice standards across information security
- We use 'bank grade' security to store and process our data
- Comply with 200+ security requirements from NAB, Woolworths and other data partners
- All partner data is held in separate restricted environments
- All access to partner data is limited to essential staff only
- Security environment and processes regularly audited by our data partners.

Ethical use of data

Applies to all facets of our work, from the initiatives we take on, the information we use and how our solutions impact individuals, organisations and society.

We all have a responsibility to use data for good

Quantium believes in using data for progress, with great care and responsibility. As such please respect the commercial in confidence nature of this document.

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Executive summary

01 Chips Category Review

- All lifestage segments spike before Christmas.
- Mainstream Young Singles/Couples generate the highest transaction.
- Mainstream Young Singles/Couples over-index on Tyrrells and Twisties.
- Older Families and Young Families buy the most chips per customer.
- Mainstream Young/Midage Singles & Couples pay a higher price per unit than their Budget and Premium. counterparts.

02 Trial Store Analysis

Control stores 233, 155, and 237 were matched with trial stores 77, 86, and 88, with 77 and 88 showing significant growth in both sales and footfall. Conversely, store 86 saw increased traffic without a sales uplift, likely due to lower unit prices or promotions that require further investigation. Overall, the trial was successful in two locations, while the third warrants a strategic review of its pricing impact.

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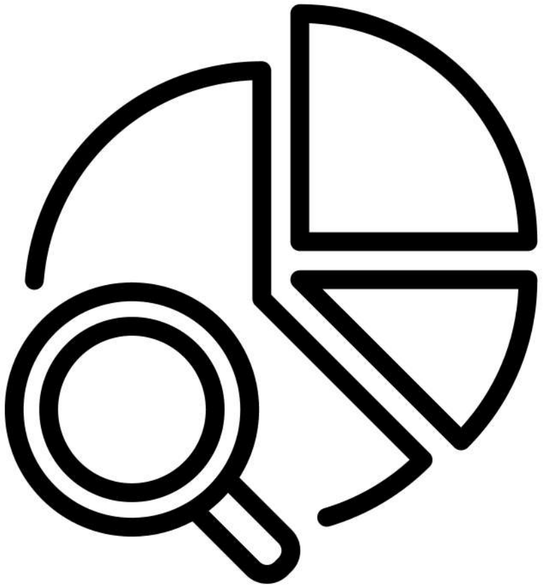
01 Category



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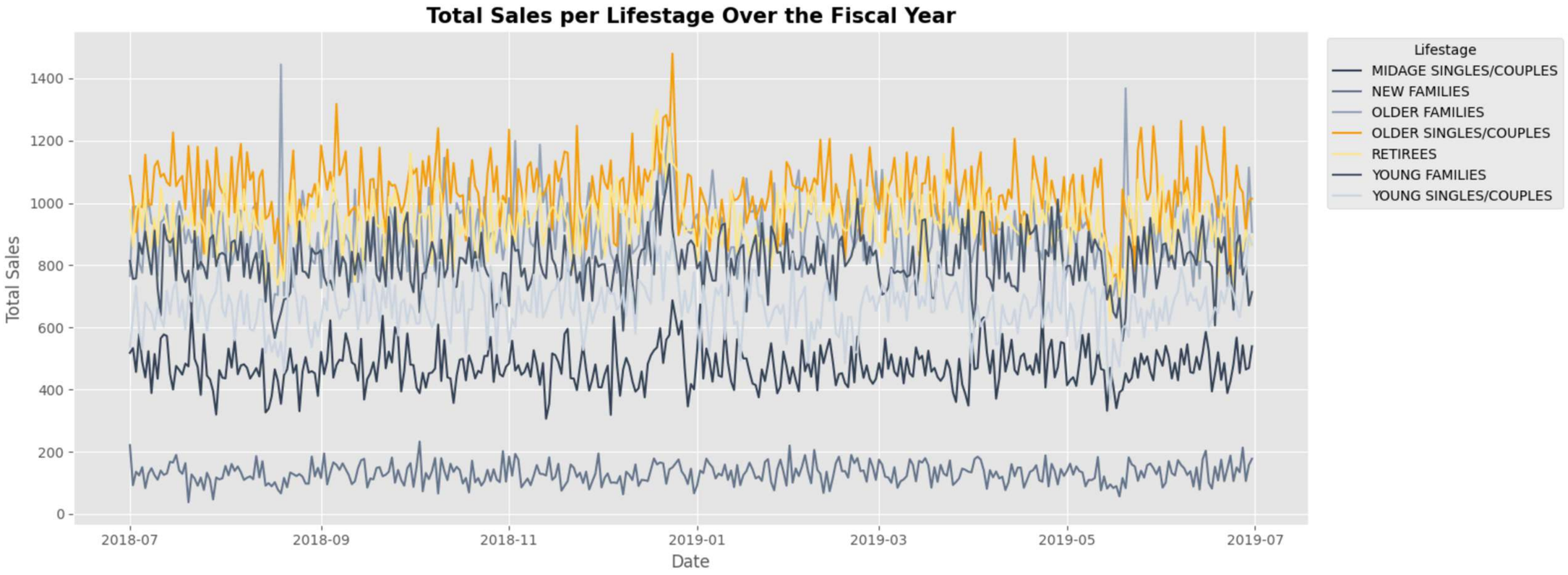
All lifestage segments spike before Christmas.



The holiday window (Dec 21–24) is the single most important promotional opportunity of the year.

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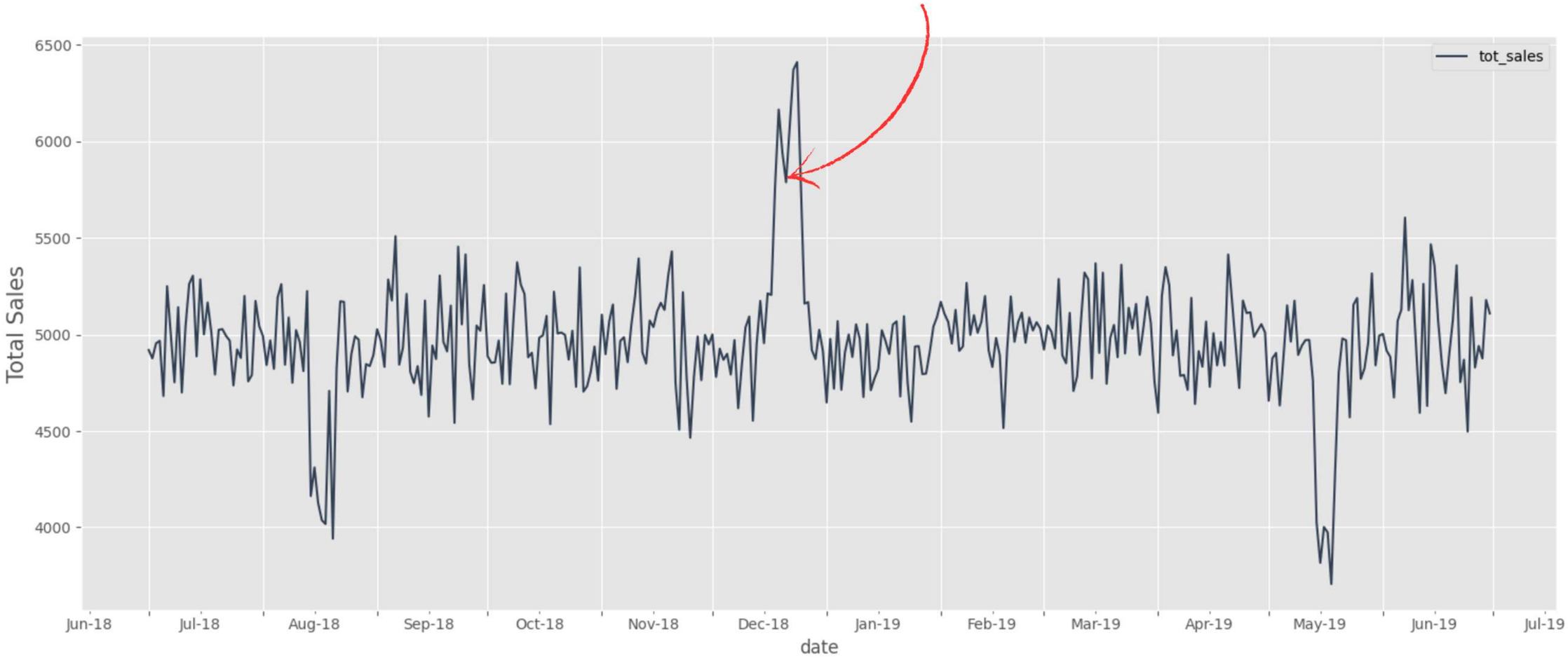
Sales follow a consistent seasonal pattern with a clear peak heading into the Christmas period and a sharp drop on Dec 25.



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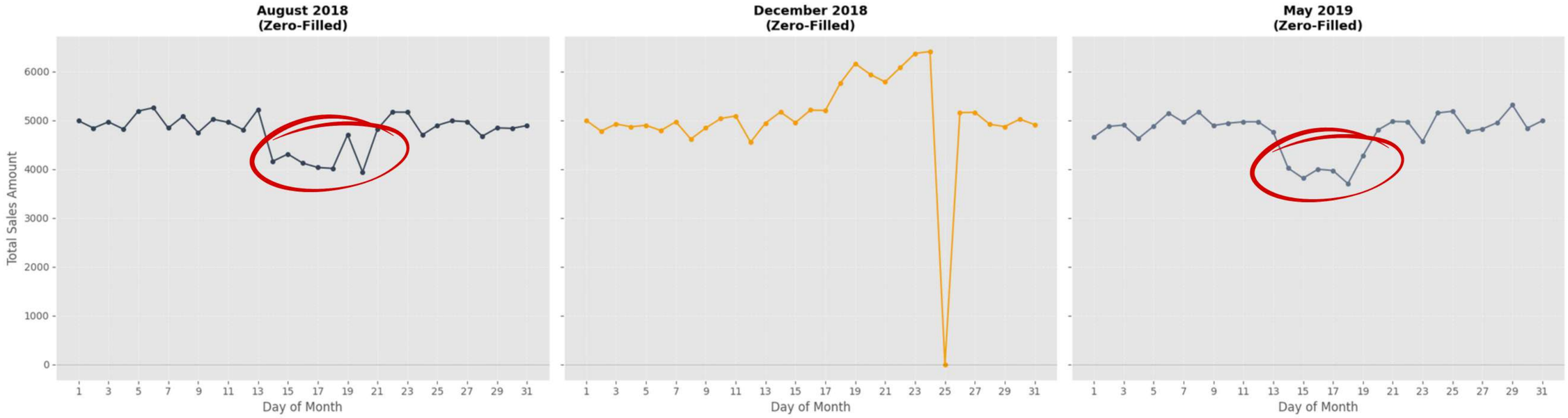

Upon reviewing the data, the drop in mid-August sales can be attributed to:

Mid-school term

Weekend effects

Seasonality

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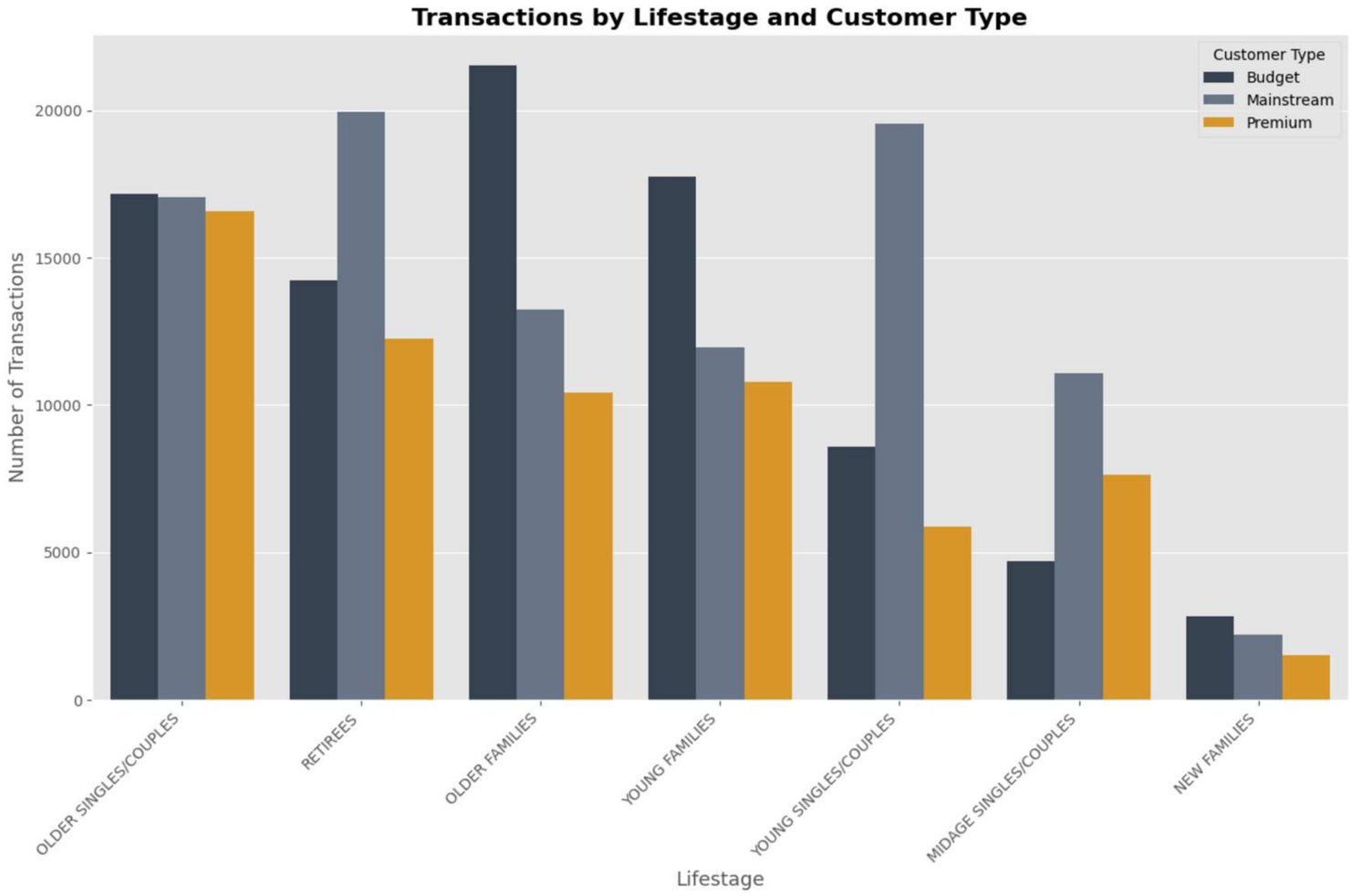
Mainstream Young Singles/Couples generate the highest transaction count across all customer types — a key segment to prioritise for promotions.



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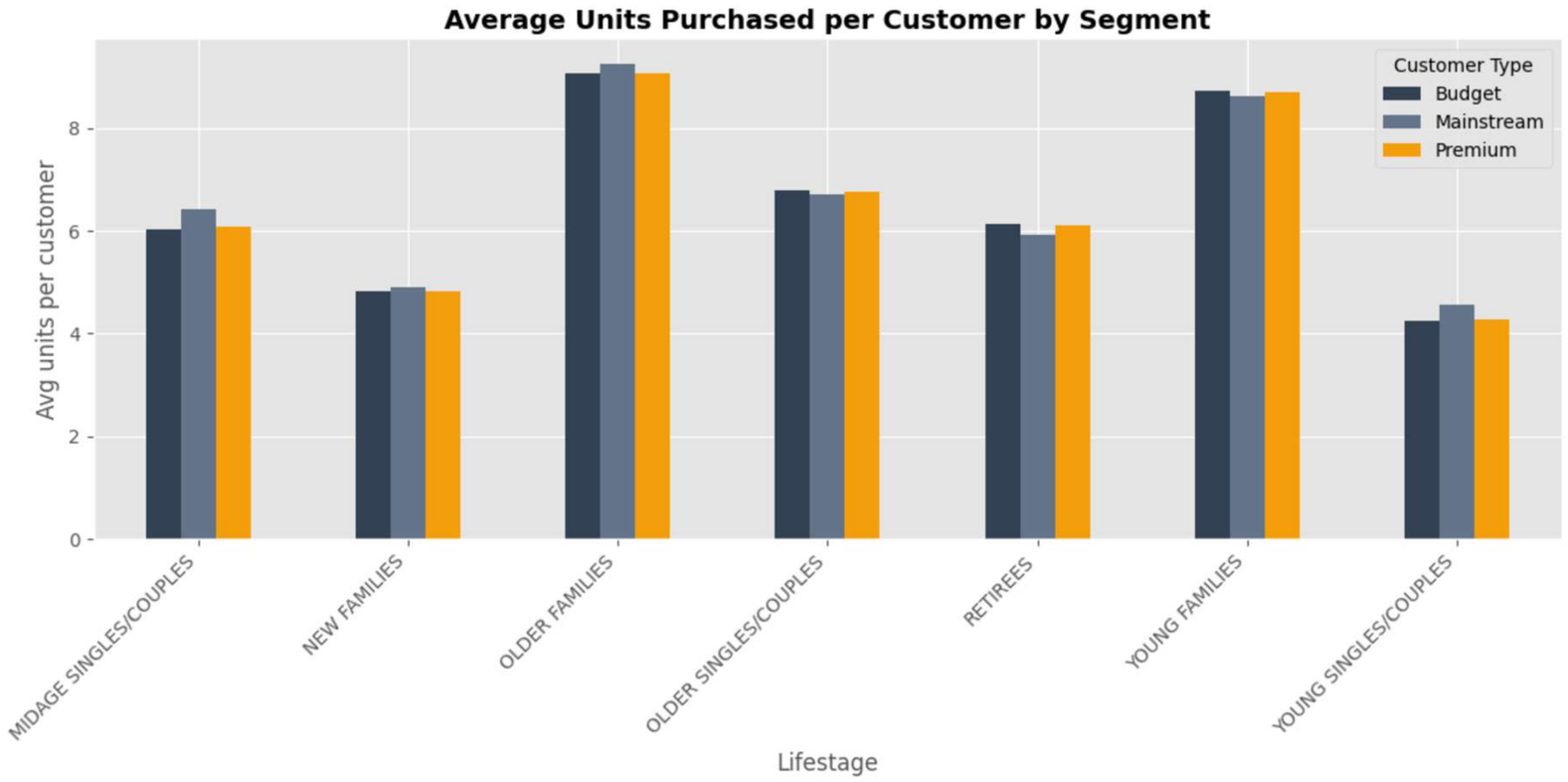
Older Families and Young Families buy the most chips per customer



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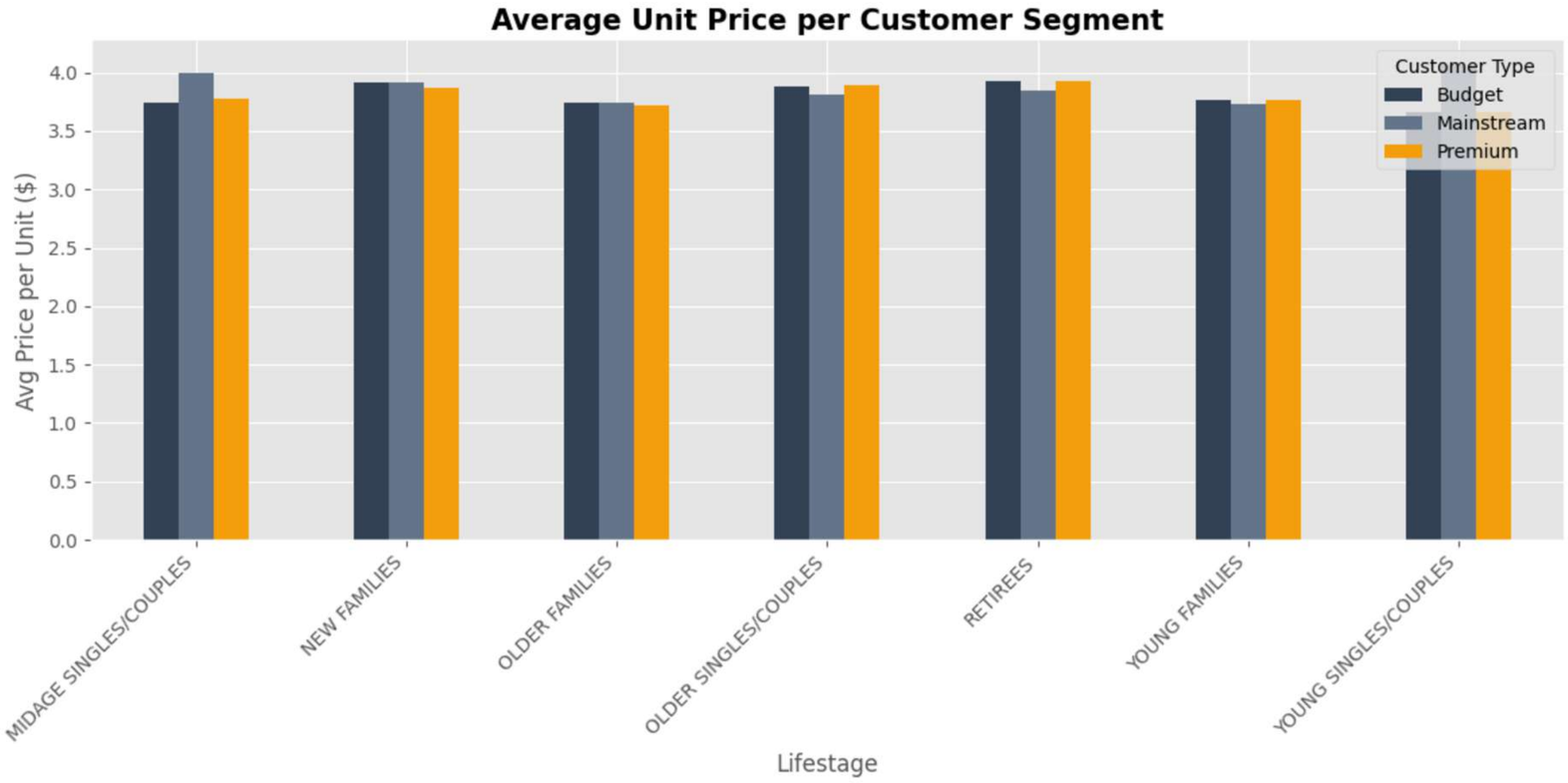
Mainstream Young/Midage Singles & Couples pay a higher price per unit than their Budget and Premium counterparts, indicating impulse buying behaviour that can be leveraged through targeted in-store placement.



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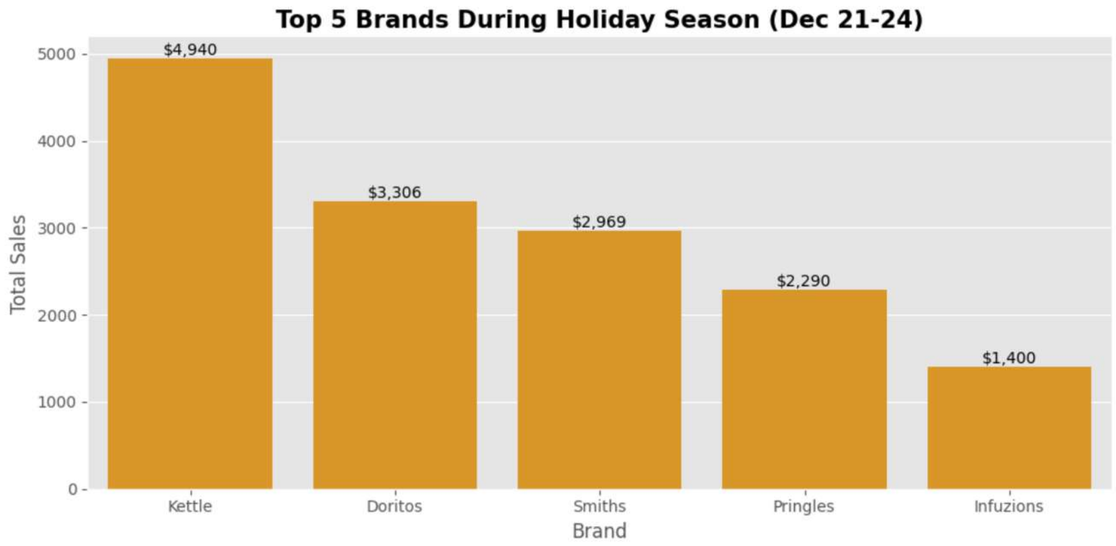
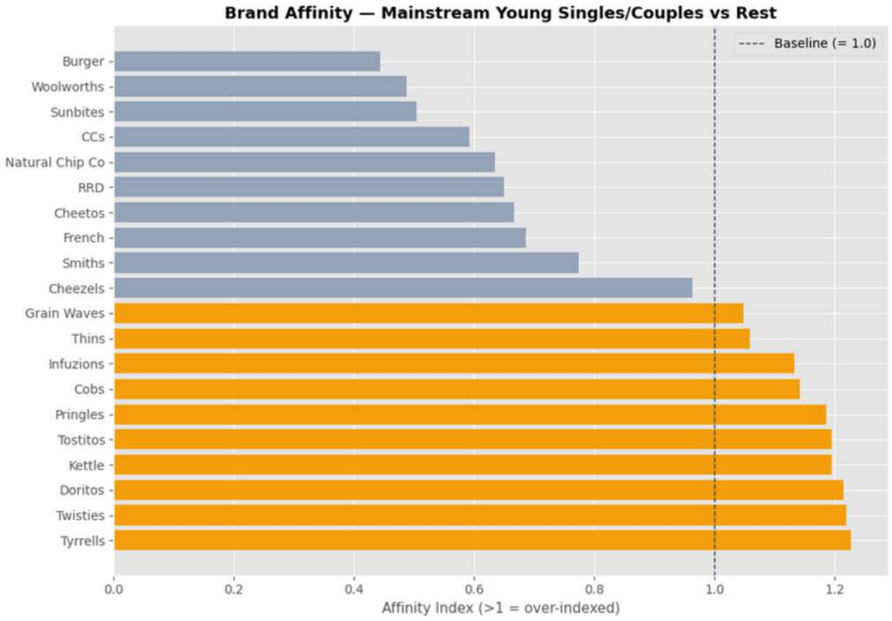
Mainstream Young Singles/Couples over-index on Tyrrells and Twisties compared to the rest of the population.





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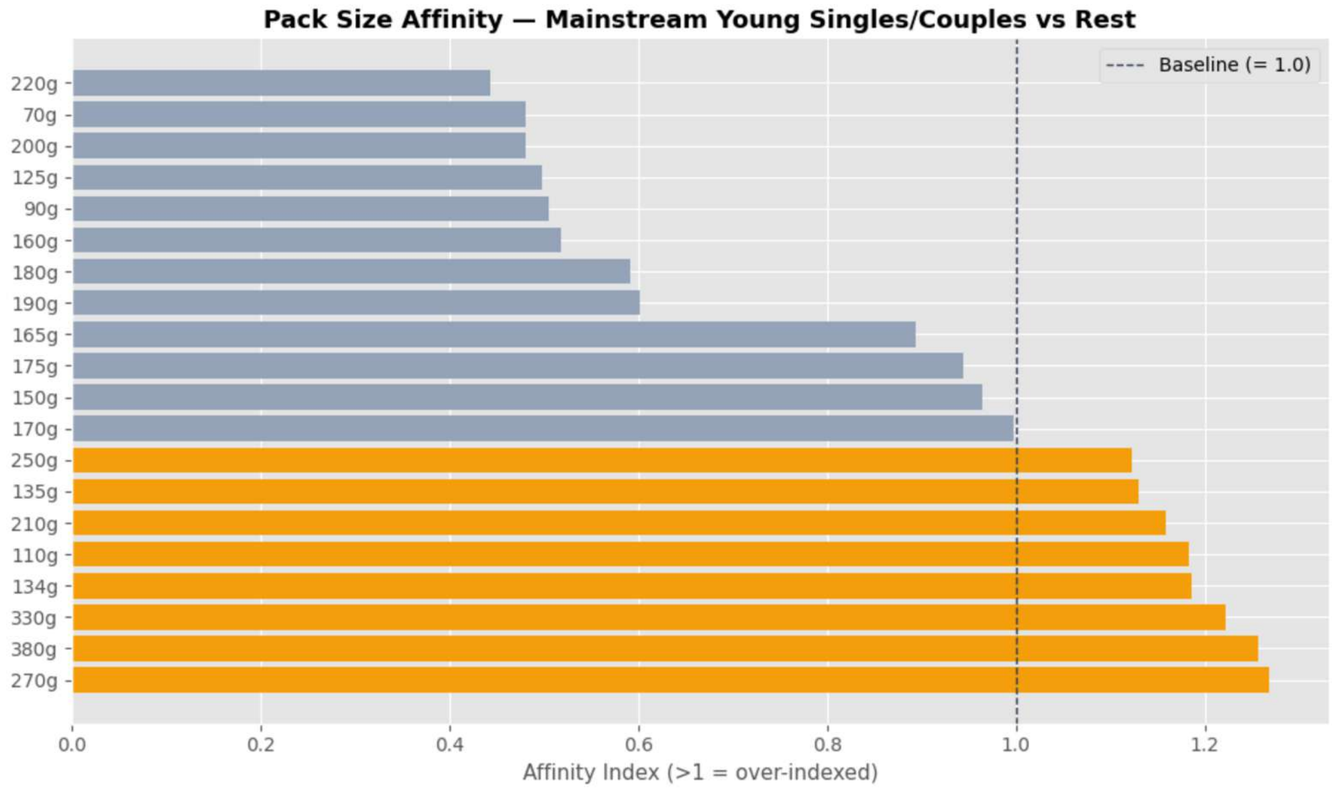
Mainstream Young Singles/Couples over-index on Tyrrells and Twisties compared to the rest of the population. These brands should be prominently placed in areas where this segment shops to maximise impulse purchases



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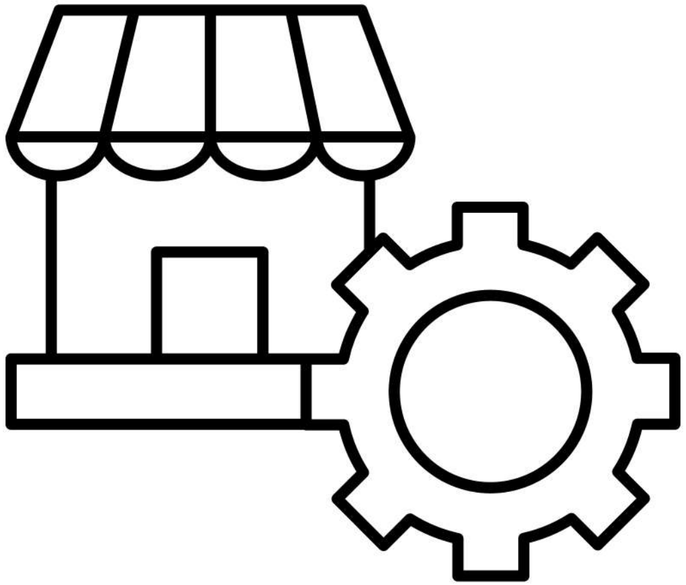
Key Findings

- Holiday season is the peak sales period — Dec 24 is the single highest day. Sales rise consistently from Dec 21, creating a clear 4-day promotional window.
- 175g packets are the best-selling size year-round. During the holiday season, 380g takes the lead.
- Kettle is the highest-selling brand both annually and during the holidays.
- Mainstream Young Singles/Couples drive the most transactions and show statistically confirmed impulse buying behaviour — they pay significantly more per unit than Budget/Premium peers (t-test $p < 2.2e-16$).
- Older & Young Families buy the most chips per customer by volume.
- Mainstream Young Singles/Couples are ~23% more likely to purchase Tyrrells and ~27% more likely to buy 270g packs (Twisties) compared to the rest of the population.
- Older Singles/Couples are the most frequent buyers by transaction count.

Recommendations

- Target Mainstream Young Singles/Couples with Tyrrells and Twisties (270g) placements in high-traffic discretionary locations — their impulse buying behaviour makes in-store placement highly effective.
- Concentrate promotional spend between Dec 21–24 to capitalise on the proven pre-Christmas sales spike.
- Stock and promote 380g packs prominently during the holiday season, as customers trade up to larger sizes.
- Drive volume for Older/Young Families through multi-buy promotions given their higher units-per-customer rate.

02 Trial store performance



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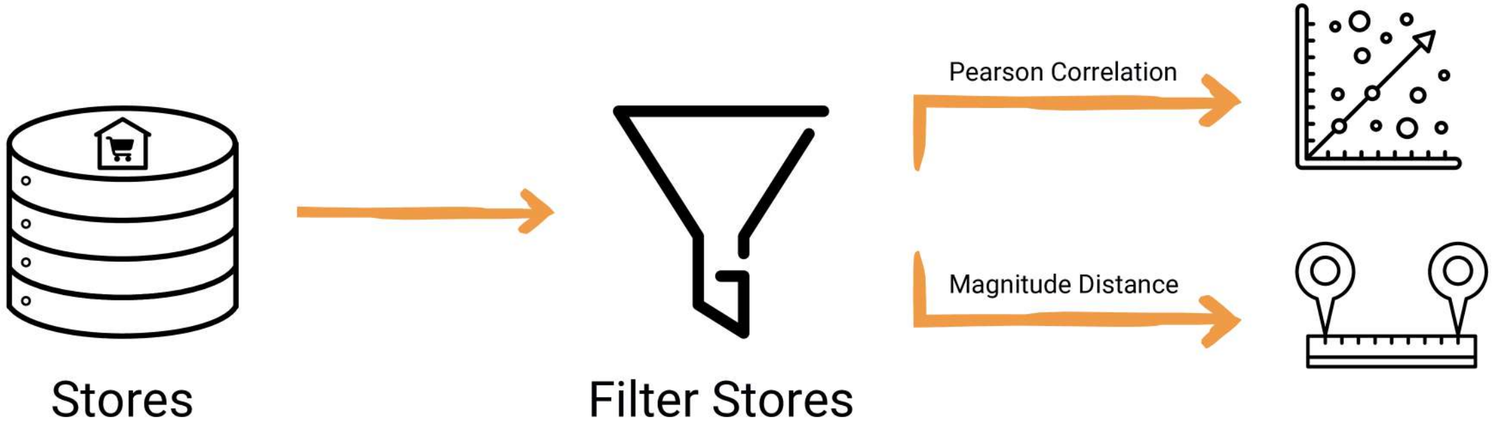
To Find Control Store



Trial Store	Control Store
77	233
86	155
88	237

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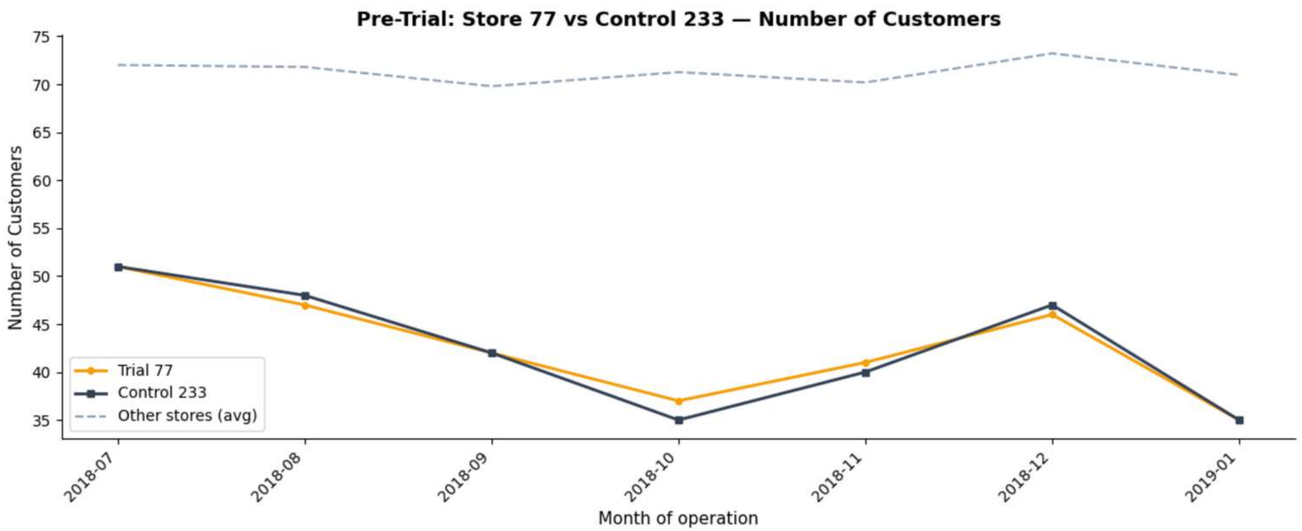
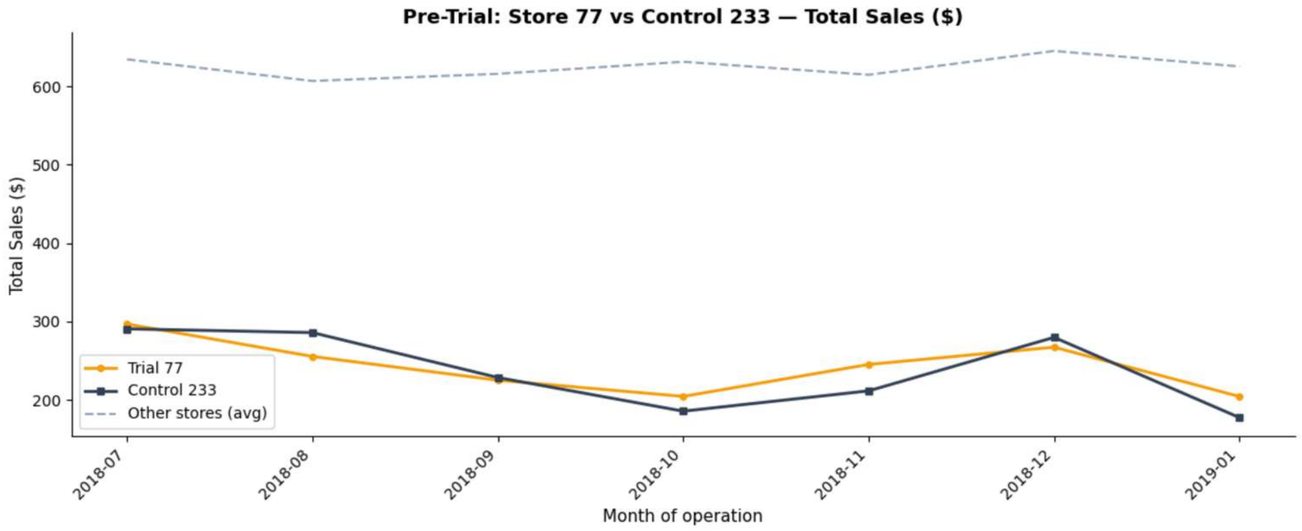
Pre-Trial Visual Check





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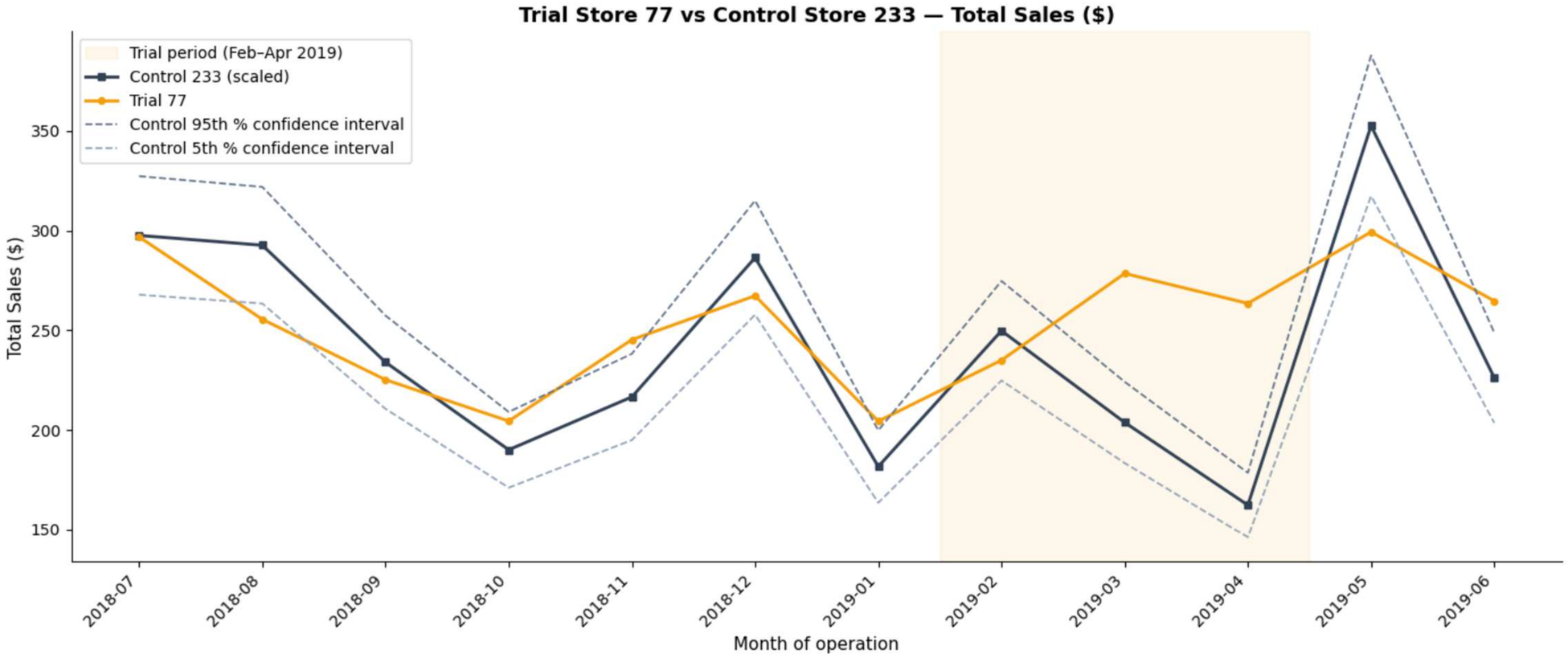
Trial Period Assessment — Total Sales



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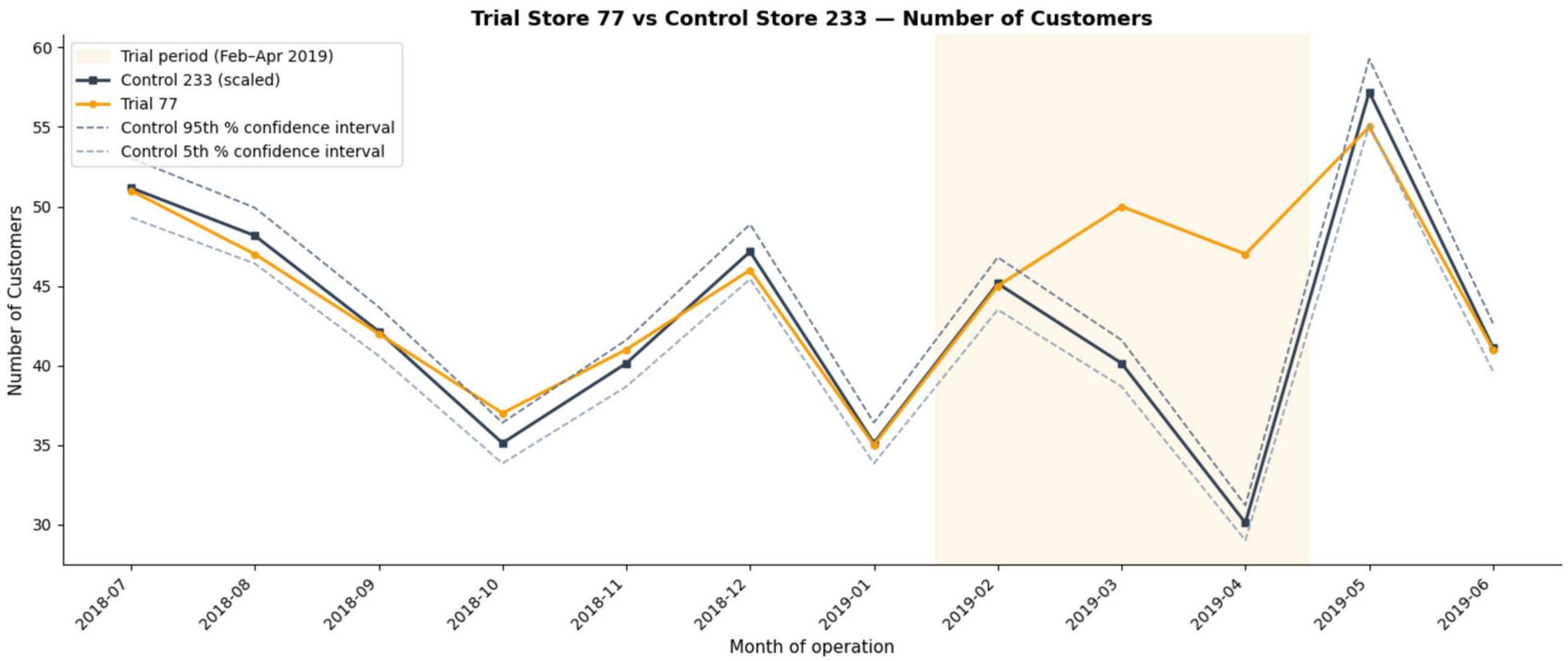
Trial Period Assessment — Number of Customers



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Key Findings

- Control stores identified: Store 233 for trial store 77, store 155 for trial store 86, and store 237 for trial store 88.
- Store 77 showed a statistically significant increase in both total sales and number of customers in two of the three trial months (March and April 2019). The uplift is driven by increased customer traffic.
- Store 86 did not show broadly significant sales uplift despite a significant increase in customer numbers across all three trial months. This discrepancy suggests that unit prices may have been lower during the trial, potentially due to in-store promotions — worth investigating with the Category Manager.
- Store 88 showed a statistically significant increase in both total sales and customer numbers in two of the three trial months — the trial had a clear positive effect.

Recommendations

- Roll out the trial layout to stores similar to stores 77 and 88, where both sales and customer number uplifts are statistically confirmed.
- Investigate store 86 pricing during the trial period to understand whether promotional discounts suppressed the full revenue impact of the increased customer footfall.
- The primary driver of uplift is customer acquisition, not increased spend per visit — layout decisions should therefore prioritise product visibility and accessibility to attract new shoppers.
- Overall the trial shows a significant positive result across two of the three trial stores, supporting a broader rollout recommendation to the Category Manager.

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